

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 4
 ♥ Q 10 7 3
 ♦ 10 9 4
 ♣ 9 4 3

♠ Q 10 5

♥ 8 6 4

♦ A 7 5

♣ K Q 8 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 6 2

♥ J 9 5

♦ Q J 6 2

♣ 10 7

♠ 8 7 3

♥ A K 2

♦ K 8 3

♣ A J 5 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
Pass	3NT		1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

small ♠ and finesse the ♠ 10. Suppose East wins the ♠ K and returns a ♥. Take your ♥ A and play another ♠, going up with the ♠ Q if West plays low. If the ♠ Q wins, take your 9 tricks and run.

Although this doesn't look like a normal A Q finesse it really is about the same.

Whenever the ♠ A and ♠ K are in different hands, the only thing that matters is the location of the ♠ J.

So it is basically a 50% chance.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥ 3.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=2 ♣=4 Total = 8

First things first. Win the first ♥, do not hold up. West's ♥3 indicates he has led a 4-card suit so a hold-up wouldn't help you. And if you did hold up they might pocket their ♥ trick and switch to ♦s, a suit you are no better off in.

You need to get one more winner and it will have to be a ♠ winner. You could lead toward the ♠ Q, winning a trick if West holds BOTH the ♠ A and ♠ K. Or you could finesse the ♠ 10, gaining a trick if West holds the ♠ J. Obviously the second choice is more likely.

Having won the first ♥ trick in your hand, play a

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7
♥ Q 10 8 3
♦ K J 9 2
♣ 9 8 4 2

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ A 6 5

♦ 8 6 4

♣ 6 5 3



♠ K 5 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ A 10 7

♣ 10 7

♠ A J 10 8

♥ K 4

♦ Q 5 3

♣ A K Q J

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South

finessing East's ♠K again, then play your ♠A and the rest of your winners.

South is to play 4♠. West leads the ♦2. The defenders win 3 ♦ tricks, then play a ♣.

Losers: ♠ = 0 or 1 ♥ = 0 ♦ = 3 ♣ = 0 Total = 3 or 4

Since you have already lost 3 ♦ tricks you cannot also lose a ♠ trick. That means East will have to have the ♠K and it also means that you will have to be careful with your finessing.

In your hand with a ♣ you play over to dummy's ♥A. Now lead the ♠Q from dummy and when East plays low play the ♠J (or 10) from your hand.

The ♠Q held the trick so you are still in dummy. Play the ♠9, and when East doesn't cover, play your ♠8 under it. West shows out on this trick and you are glad you played so carefully. Play one more ♠,

If you had played the ♠Q and carelessly followed with the ♠8 on your first finesse you would have gone down. You would have had to win the second finesse in your hand and would have no dummy entry to let you take the third finesse.

True, the chances of East holding 4 ♠s to the King are pretty small, but it costs you nothing to protect yourself against that holding.

And the rewards are great.